

In Plants vs. Zombies: Garden Warfare Series, we have the Plasma Pea: a great example of a system of avatars that overcomes human-centric biases through its abstract, non-human qualities.

Avatar Analysis: Plasma Pea

- https://static.wikia.nocookie.net/plantsvszombies/images/b/b8/Plasma_PeaGW1.png/revision/latest/scale-to-width/360?cb=20190530164817
- <https://static.wikia.nocookie.net/plantsvszombies/images/b/b0/PlasmaPeaLegendsoftheLawnDLCPromotionalArt.jpg/revision/latest/scale-to-width-down/250?cb=20190306063025>

The Plasma Pea has a blue, hazy color to its skin, with two blank white eyes; in the first image, it looks as if the whole universe is in the skin. By using a cosmic theme, the developers of the game manage to completely overcome all types of sexism and ethnic bias with this avatar. Not only is this avatar gender and ethnic-neutral, it's also a brilliant way to allow players to immerse themselves into the avatar without ticking a box about their physical information.

Connection to Course Concepts:

This avatar is the perfect example of Identity Signaling, because in this instance, instead of belonging to a group, one can see it as a declaration of being a "cosmic" power, or wanting to have a high-tier, technical character. Players can convey a sense of wonder, mystery and an omnipotent feeling that isn't found in their personal lives with this avatar.

Furthermore, it is also a great example of Agency. The avatar can charge its shots as displayed in the second picture, giving the player incredible mechanical control of the battlefield. Given its nearly "infinite potential," players can create a Social Presence based entirely on skill and having the identity of a god-like protector, allowing for a robust form of character customization without archetypes.